Catholic Morality: Chapters 4 & 5 cram sheet

Jesus as Moral Guide and Conscience Formation. Test: 50 questions (multiple choice, true/false, matching) plus one essay of about 7 to 8 sentences.

The eight Beatitudes

Blessed are...	for they...
1. the poor in spirit (**anawim**)	theirs is the kingdom of heaven
2. they who mourn	will be comforted
3. the meek (not weak; right use of anger)	will inherit the land
4. they who hunger and thirst for righteousness	will be satisfied
5. the merciful (empathy, forgive)	will be shown mercy
6. the clean of heart (see as God sees)	will see God
7. the peacemakers (**shalom**)	will be called children of God
8. they who are persecuted for righteousness	theirs is the kingdom of heaven

- **Beatitude** = supreme happiness. Taught at the start of the **Sermon on the Mount** (Matthew 5 to 7). They call you to embrace the Kingdom of God, the vision of God, the joy of the Lord, God's rest.
- **Beatific Vision**: contemplation of God in heavenly glory. The Kingdom has a present dimension: be salt and light now.

Jesus, the moral norm

- Moral norm because he is **God incarnate**, human and divine; he redeemed, sanctified, justified us. Qualities: compassionate, truthful, accepted all, treated women and men equally, sensitive to children, prayerful.
- **Kingdom of God**: God reconciling and renewing all things; begun in Jesus, completed at the end of time; peace, justice, love.
- **Repentance** (metanoia): sorry in heart, mind, will; resolve not to sin. Faith + grace.
- **Great Commandment**: love God with all your heart, soul, mind; love neighbor as yourself.
- **Corporal works of mercy**: feed the hungry, give drink to the thirsty, clothe the naked, shelter the homeless, visit the sick, visit the imprisoned, bury the dead.

Sermon on the Mount

Old Law	New Law
Do not kill	Control anger; reconcile
No adultery	No lust in the heart
Bill of divorce	Marriage is lifelong
No false oaths	Yes means yes (integrity)
Eye for an eye	Turn the other cheek
Hate your enemy	Love your enemies

- Jesus fulfills, not abolishes: **spirit over the letter**, a law of love. Matthew 6: clean heart, pure intentions, trust in God; almsgiving, prayer, fasting done humbly.
- **Golden Rule**: do to others whatever you would have them do to you. Closing rules: narrow gate; pray with trust; build on Christ's words. Own-words prayer = **spontaneous prayer**.

Virtues, gifts, fruits

- **Cardinal** (gained by effort): prudence (applies principles), justice (gives due), fortitude (courage), temperance (moderation).
- **Theological** (infused by God): faith, hope, charity (the greatest; agape = selfless love).
- Against faith: incredulity, **heresy** (deny a truth), **apostasy** (reject Christ totally), **schism** (refuse the pope). Against hope: despair, presumption. Against charity: indifference, ingratitude, lukewarmness, hatred.
- **7 gifts**: wisdom, understanding, counsel, fortitude, knowledge, piety, fear of the Lord. **12 fruits**: charity, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, generosity, gentleness, faithfulness, modesty, self-control, chastity.
- **Character**: your response to God's invitation to love. Good character: loving, fully human, virtuous. **Sacramental character**: indelible mark of Baptism, Confirmation, Holy Orders.

Discipleship

- **Priest**: offer daily life as sacrifice. **Prophet**: proclaim Christ. **King**: self-mastery, justice, service. Begins at Baptism; Confirmation strengthens.
- **Evangelical counsels**: poverty, chastity, obedience. Contemplative orders emphasize prayer; apostolic orders, active ministry; hermits withdraw in prayer; some lay groups pledge the counsels without vows. The **laity** are not ordained.

Conscience

- **Conscience**: a practical judgment of reason about the goodness or evil of an act; form it, then follow it. Where you are alone with God.
- **NOT**: majority opinion, a feeling, the superego (Freud), a gut instinct, Jiminy Cricket, just guilt.
- **IS** (Vatican II): law written on the heart; summons to good; binding; inner sanctuary; reveals divine law of love.
- 3 aspects: relationship with God, awareness of God's call to love, practical judgment of the intellect. 4 tasks: urge good, keep from evil, guide, judge past acts.
- 2 principles: always form and inform it; always obey your **certain** conscience.
- **SEER**: Study the facts, Elect (with prayer), **Execute** (the true test), Review. A seer is a prophet.
- **Examination of conscience**: honest, prayerful assessment of how well you lived God's covenant of love; for the Sacrament of Penance.

Erroneous judgment

Invincible ignorance	Vincible ignorance
Cannot be overcome; NOT culpable (the act is still evil)	Could be overcome; culpable (cared little for truth)

- Uncertain conscience: get more formation. Habitual sin makes conscience "sightless." Also: ignorance of Christ, bad example, passions, false autonomy, rejecting the Church, no repentance, no love.
- **Primacy of conscience** = no one may force you against it. **God's law** is the final judge, not individual conscience.

Peer pressure and fortitude

- Neutral (fads), positive (inspires good), negative (pushes wrong; "Everyone is doing it").
- Strategies: know your standards; learn to say no; avoid tempting situations; pray.
- **Fortitude**: firmness in difficulties; grown by self-denial, prayer, service; ultimate act is **martyrdom**. Offering up builds it.

Key: SEER = Study, Elect, Execute, Review.